Owen Brooks

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EDUCATION

University of Oregon Eugene, OR
Bachelor of Science in Economics *Expected June 2028*

- GPA: 4.0/4.0 (Unweighted), 4.25/4.3 (Internal UO Scale)
- Honors: Dean's List, All Semesters (Fall 2024 – Present)
- Relevant Coursework: Econometrics I & II (ECON 320, 421), Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Globalization (ECON 482), Calculus II–III (MATH 252–253), Differential Equations (MATH 256), Introduction to Proofs, International Economic Issues

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Quantitative international trade, global value chains, economic history, U.S. trade policy, Eaton-Kortum trade models, input-output linkages, dynamic macroeconomics

PUBLICATIONS

Working Papers Brooks, O. "The McKinley Tariff of 1890: Input-Output Amplification and Sectoral Reallocation." Working Paper, University of Oregon, 2025. *(Writing sample available upon request.)*

PRESENTATIONS

"The McKinley Tariff of 1890: Input-Output Amplification and Sectoral Reallocation." Graduate Trade Reading Group, Department of Economics, University of Oregon, Eugene, OR. 2025–2026.
"Legal History of the Venezuela-Guyana Essequibo Border Dispute." University of Oregon Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium, Eugene, OR. May 2025.

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

CURE Fellow Summer 2025
Center for Undergraduate Research and Engagement *University of Oregon*

- Competitive grant awarded to conduct independent economics research; produced working paper applying Caliendo–Parro (2015) to novel historical tariff-line data

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

CURE Fellow – Economics Research Summer 2025 – Present
Department of Economics, University of Oregon *Eugene, OR*

- Engineered ML-based OCR pipeline to extract and structure commodity-level trade data from 19th-century government publications, automating digitization of thousands of tariff-line records from scanned primary sources
- Constructed novel tariff-line level U.S. trade dataset from *Foreign Commerce and Navigation of the United States* (1880–1900), digitizing commodity-level bilateral flows not previously available in digital form
- Calibrated Caliendo–Parro (2015) multi-sector Ricardian trade model to 21 sectors using 1890 U.S. Census of Manufacturing production data and newly digitized tariff schedules; computed counterfactual aggregate welfare effect of +0.304% under small open economy assumption
- Identified structural heterogeneity in the McKinley Tariff schedule — diverging sectoral rate changes masked by import-weighted aggregates — and traced input-output amplification to upstream sectors on the statutory free list

- Validated tariff wedge estimates via OLS regression; computed counterfactual price indices via hat algebra fixed-point iteration
- Supervised by Prof. Woan Foong Wong, Associate Professor of Economics

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Peer Mentor September 2025 – Present
Global Engagement Academic Residential Community (GE ARC) *University of Oregon*

- Provide academic mentorship to students in the Global Engagement living-learning community, connecting residents to research opportunities and faculty programs as a former GE ARC resident

Secretary September 2024 – Present
University of Oregon Undergraduate Law Association *Eugene, OR*

- Coordinate operations for one of the largest student organizations on campus; manage meetings with 80+ attendees, communications, and member records
- Collaborate with executive board to organize events, guest speaker sessions, and law school preparation workshops

SKILLS

Technical: General equilibrium calibration, Caliendo–Parro/Eaton–Kortum trade modelling, global value chain analysis, counterfactual analysis, input-output analysis, structural gravity estimation, dynamic macroeconomic modelling, OLS regression, historical data digitization

Software: R, Python (Pandas, PyTorch, SciPy), LaTeX, Bash, Linux, AWS (Textract), Google AI Studio, Microsoft Excel, Claude Code

Languages: English (native)

REFERENCES

Woan Foong Wong
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Department of Economics, University of Oregon
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